

Remote Tools & Communication Guide

Northlight Analytics | Internal Reference | Updated Quarterly

Our Core Tools

Tool	Primary Use
Slack	Real-time chat, quick questions, team channels
Notion	Documentation, wikis, meeting notes, project specs
Zoom	Video meetings and all-hands
Linear	Engineering task and sprint tracking
Google Workspace	Email, calendar, shared drives
1Password	Credential and secret storage
Loom	Async video updates and walkthroughs

When to Use Which Channel

- Urgent, needs a response within the hour: Slack DM or @here in a relevant channel.
- Needs a decision but not urgent: post in the team channel and tag the decision-maker.
- Long-form context or a proposal: write a Notion doc and share the link.
- Explaining something visual or complex: record a Loom instead of a long message.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How fast am I expected to respond on Slack?

There is no company-wide SLA. Most teams aim to acknowledge messages within their working hours, generally same-day. Set your Slack status if you're heads-down or away.

Q: Do I need to keep my camera on during meetings?

Cameras are encouraged for team meetings and 1:1s but not mandatory. For large all-hands, cameras are optional for everyone except the presenter.

Q: What if I'm going to miss a deadline?

Flag it to your manager as early as possible in Slack or your team's async standup. Early flags are always viewed more positively than a missed deadline with no warning.

Q: How do I request access to a new tool?

Post in #it-requests with the tool name and business justification. Most requests are approved or answered within 2 business days.

Q: Where do I find past meeting recordings?

All recorded meetings are automatically uploaded to the shared 'Meeting Recordings' folder in Google Drive and linked from the relevant Notion project page.

Q: Who do I contact if a tool is down?

Check #status-updates first for known outages, then post in #it-support if the issue isn't already reported.